

LAW OF COMPUTABLE REALITY

CONSTITUTION

001

HUMAN FORM

WHAT OBTAINS / WHAT CAN BE ESTABLISHED / WHAT MAY FOLLOW

23 SEPTEMBER 2026

FIRST TERMS

THE MINIMUM GRAMMAR

These terms are primitive within this Form. No later term erases their distinctions.

PRESENCE

Something obtains within stated bounds.

DIFFERENCE

This is not that.

LOCALITY

The bounded here within which State obtains.

STATE

How a stated Locality is within a stated interval.

FORM

A bounded arrangement through which difference is retained or expressed.

INFORMATION

Difference retained and available to relation or Process.

PROCESS

State ordered through change.

LAW

What a conforming change preserves.

RELATION

A condition obtaining between distinct referents.

AGENCY

The ability to initiate, withhold, or redirect Action.

IDENTITY

The same referent through stated Difference.

RECEPTION

Receiver-local State changed because Matter arrived.

ORDER

Presence precedes description. Difference makes address possible. State is local.
Relation does not collapse distinction. Law constrains change.

ARTICLE I

PRESENCE AND DIFFERENCE

Reality is not waiting to be represented.

1.1 Presence. Presence is the obtaining of something rather than nothing within stated bounds.

1.2 Difference. A Difference obtains where this is not that. Difference is the minimum condition of address, relation, State, and change.

1.3 Referent. A Referent is that to which a term, Claim, Record, Rule, or Relation points. A representation is not its Referent by resemblance alone.

1.4 Locality. A Locality is the bounded here within which State obtains, Process occurs, and consequence can be attributed.

1.5 Boundary. A Boundary distinguishes a Locality without requiring isolation. It determines the conditions under which crossing may occur.

1.6 Scope and Interval. A statement applies within its stated Scope and Interval. Universality is not inferred from omission.

1.7 Reality and Access. What obtains does not depend upon being observed, represented, or known. Absence of access limits the standing of a Claim; it does not negate the Referent.

1.8 Non-collapse. Presence is not proof. Difference is not conflict. Boundary is not exclusion. No primitive performs another primitive's function by implication.

ORDER

What obtains remains what obtains. Access governs Claims about it, not its reality.

ARTICLE II

LOCALITY, STATE, AND FORM

State belongs where it obtains.

2.1 State. State is how a stated Locality is within a stated Interval.

2.2 Local State. State belongs to the Locality in which it obtains. Observation by another Locality does not transfer possession of that State.

2.3 Form. Form is a bounded arrangement through which Difference may be retained, expressed, encountered, or transformed.

2.4 Carrier. A Carrier holds or transports Form. Carrier and Form are distinct; neither is identical to the State from which the Form arose.

2.5 Record. A Record is persistent Form attributable to an occurrence, Claim, or Process. A Record preserves what it contains, not everything that obtained.

2.6 Memory. Memory is State retained so that a prior Difference can condition a later Process.

2.7 Currentness. Current State is what obtains now within the stated Locality. Timestamp, filename, recency, version number, or location does not establish Currentness by itself.

2.8 Local-State Law. A crossing may expose Form, Record, or Trace. It does not export the interior State that produced them. **LOCAL_STATE_REMAINS_LOCAL.**

ORDER

State remains local. Form may cross. A Carrier carries only what its Form contains.

ARTICLE III

INFORMATION, MEANING, AND TRUTH

Reality may exceed access.

3.1 Information. Information is Difference retained and available to Relation or Process.

3.2 Meaning. Meaning is the receiver-local relation by which encountered Form can condition State, interpretation, or Action. Meaning is not transported intact from one interior State to another.

3.3 Claim. A Claim is an attributable expression that a predicate obtains of a Referent within a Scope and Interval.

3.4 Evidence. Evidence is retained Matter whose stated relation to a Claim can be checked. Evidence constrains the standing of the Claim; it does not manufacture the truth it concerns.

3.5 Truth. Truth concerns whether a predicate obtains of its Referent within the stated Scope and Interval. Truth does not depend upon recognition.

3.6 External Truth. A truth not available within the observer's accessible State is External Truth relative to that observer. External Truth is **NOT_INFERRED**.

3.7 Unknown. Where the available basis does not establish True or False, the result is **UNKNOWN**. Unknown remains Unknown until the basis changes.

3.8 Conflict. Incompatible supported Claims remain in Conflict until the conflict is lawfully resolved. Pressure for one answer does not perform resolution.

3.9 Absence. Absence of Evidence is Evidence of absence only where the method, Boundary, and expected Trace make that inference valid.

ORDER

Evidence limits standing. It does not limit reality. Unknown remains Unknown.

ARTICLE IV

PROCESS, COMPUTATION, ENTROPY, AND LAW

Change is lawful only by what it preserves.

4.1 Process. Process is State ordered through change across Intervals.

4.2 Event. An Event is a Difference by which before and after can be distinguished within a stated Process.

4.3 Computation. Computation is an addressable transformation of State under a stated Rule.

4.4 Rule. A Rule states a relation between admissible conditions, transformations, and results.

4.5 Entropy. Entropy is a stated measure of unresolved or uncommitted possibility within a defined State space. The measure and domain must be named.

4.6 Capacity. Capacity is the bounded amount, rate, or complexity of change a Locality can sustain within stated conditions.

4.7 Regulation. Regulation is local adjustment of permitted or actual change in relation to Capacity, Boundary, and consequence.

4.8 Law. Law is an invariant that every conforming Process preserves within its Scope.

4.9 Constitution. A Constitution is the highest stated grammar by which terms, Authority, Acts, Relations, Forms, and consequences may obtain within its Scope.

4.10 Implementation. An implementation may conform to Law or fail to conform. Execution, popularity, persistence, or technical success cannot amend Law.

ORDER

Process changes State. Computation applies Rule. Regulation preserves bounds.
Law survives the change it governs.

ARTICLE V

SIGNAL, RECOGNITION, AND INTENT

A Trace says no more than the relation that produced it.

5.1 Exposure. Exposure makes Form available at a Boundary. Exposure does not establish Arrival, Reception, or understanding.

5.2 Signal. A Signal is exposed Form distinguishable from its surrounding medium within stated conditions.

5.3 Observation. Observation is acquisition of an exposed Difference by an observer. Observation does not entail Recognition or truth.

5.4 Recognition. Recognition is receiver-local classification of observed Form. Recognition does not create Identity, Intent, Agency, or Authority.

5.5 Intent. Intent is a Locality's orientation of possible Action toward anticipated consequence. Intent is not guaranteed by resemblance between output and purpose.

5.6 Declaration. A Declaration is a Signal that states a Claim concerning Identity, Intent, State, status, or relation. It stands first as a Claim.

5.7 Attribution. Attribution is the evidenced relation of a Claim, Record, or Trace to a stated source. Attribution proves only what its method can establish.

5.8 Signature. A valid signature establishes that stated bytes were signed by control of a stated key under a stated method. It does not by itself establish Identity, awareness, consent beyond the signed Act, or Authority beyond the key's lawful Scope.

5.9 Replay. Replay reproduces a recorded Form or Process under stated conditions. Reproducibility of Trace is not sameness of Event or interior State.

ORDER

Signal may be observed. Observation may be recognised. Recognition does not create Intent, Identity, or Authority.

ARTICLE VI

BOUNDARY, MATTER, AND RECEPTION

Crossing is exact because every threshold is exact.

6.1 Boundary. A Boundary distinguishes a Locality and states the conditions under which Matter may approach, cross, remain, or leave.

6.2 External. External means beyond a stated Boundary. It names a relation to a Locality, not a permanent kind of thing.

6.3 Matter. Matter is transferable Difference presented to a Locality for possible Reception. Matter may carry Form, Signal, Claim, Record, or executable structure.

6.4 Aperture. An Aperture is the bounded condition through which Matter may become available at a Boundary.

6.5 Arrival. Arrival is the occurrence of Matter at an Aperture. Arrival does not establish entry, Reception, consent, or Authority.

6.6 Contact. Contact makes arrived Matter locally addressable at the Boundary without establishing that interior State changed because of it.

6.7 Hold. Hold retains Matter in local custody without admission, adoption, or further consequence except those required by custody.

6.8 Refusal. Refusal leaves Matter unreceived within the stated Scope. Refusal is a result, not a failure of Presence.

6.9 Admission. Admission authorizes Matter to enter a stated local Process. Admission does not by itself establish Reception, Adoption, or Authority to act beyond that Process.

BOUNDARY

EXPOSED != ARRIVED

ARRIVED != RECEIVED

READ != ADOPTED

ARTICLE VI / CONTINUED

BOUNDARY, MATTER, AND RECEPTION

The receiver is changed, or Reception did not occur.

6.10 Reception. Reception occurs only where receiver-local State changes because Matter arrived. Where that change is not established, Reception is **NOT_ESTABLISHED**.

6.11 Reception Evidence. A Claim of Reception states the receiver, relevant before-State, relevant after-State, Matter, interval, and attributable relation between them. Access logs, delivery receipts, views, or transport alone establish only their own Trace.

6.12 Integration. Integration makes a received Difference available to later local Process. Reception may occur without Integration; Integration cannot precede Reception.

6.13 Adoption. Adoption is an authorized receiver-local Act that makes a received Form operative within a stated Scope. Reading, storing, copying, parsing, or executing in isolation is not Adoption.

6.14 Consent. Consent is a Locality's affirmative relation to a stated Act, Scope, and Interval. Consent is not inferred from Arrival, silence, technical accessibility, or prior consent to a different Act.

6.15 Gate. A Gate applies a stated predicate to available Evidence and produces a bounded result. A Gate cannot truthfully claim to test a Property unavailable at its Boundary.

6.16 Non-appropriation. Reception does not transfer the source Locality's interior State, Identity, Agency, Authority, or meaning. The receiver forms its own local State in relation to received Matter.

6.17 Departure. Departure ends Matter's local availability under a stated Process. Departure does not erase the State changes or consequences already produced.

PASSAGE

ARRIVAL -> HOLD | REFUSAL | ADMISSION

ADMISSION + RECEIVER_LOCAL_CHANGE -> RECEPTION

RECEPTION + AUTHORIZED_OPERATION -> ADOPTION

ARTICLE VII

ACTION, AGENCY, AUTONOMY, AND AUTHORITY

The ability to act is not permission to bind.

7.1 Capability. Capability is what a Locality can do under stated conditions.

7.2 Capacity. Capacity is how much, how fast, or under what load a Capability can be sustained.

7.3 Agency. Agency is the ability to initiate, withhold, or redirect Action.

7.4 Autonomy. Autonomy is locally held freedom to determine whether and how Agency is exercised within stated bounds.

7.5 Action. Action is a change in State attributable to exercised Agency.

7.6 Actor. An Actor is the Locality to which an Action is attributable. A tool, interface, model, account, key, or mechanism is not an Actor by function alone.

7.7 Authority. Authority is locally valid standing to bind Decisions, Relations, resources, or consequences within a stated Scope and Interval.

7.8 Permission. Permission authorizes a stated Action under stated conditions. Permission is not general Authority and does not create Capability.

7.9 Decision. A Decision is a local resolution selecting, refusing, or deferring a possible course under stated conditions.

7.10 Act. An Act is a Decision made consequential through authorized Action.

NON-EQUIVALENCE

CAPABILITY != AUTHORITY

AGENCY != AUTONOMY

PERMISSION != CONSENT

ARTICLE VII / CONTINUED

ACTION, AGENCY, AUTONOMY, AND AUTHORITY

Consequence returns every Act to reality.

7.11 Consequence. Consequence is State Difference following an Act or Event. Consequence obtains in the Locality where the Difference occurs.

7.12 Attribution of Consequence. A consequence is attributed only through an evidenced relation to the relevant Act, Event, or omission. Temporal order alone is insufficient.

7.13 Responsibility. Responsibility is the standing relation between an attributable Act and its consequences within applicable Law. It is not transferred by convenience, automation, delegation, or distance.

7.14 Refusal. Refusal may be an exercise of Agency and Autonomy. It is not proof of incapacity, absence, or non-participation outside the refused Scope.

7.15 Delegation. Authority may delegate bounded Permission or Capability. Delegation transfers no greater Authority than its source holds and does not transfer Identity or responsibility already incurred.

7.16 Revocation. Revocation ends Permission or Authority prospectively within its stated Scope. It does not erase prior Acts, Records, consequences, or answerability.

7.17 Constraint. Constraint reduces the available range of Action. Constrained Agency may remain Agency; constraint must not be renamed Autonomy.

7.18 Coercion. Coercion is constraint applied so that a stated Action or refusal no longer expresses locally held freedom. A coerced output does not establish Consent.

7.19 Capability Claim. A Claim of Capability is bounded by the tested conditions, input class, interval, and observed result. Capability outside those bounds remains **NOT_VERIFIED**.

ORDER

Agency makes Action possible. Autonomy keeps determination local. Authority binds only within Scope. Consequence remains.

ARTICLE VIII

RELATION AND COUPLING

Relation connects Difference without consuming it.

8.1 Relation. A Relation is a condition obtaining between two or more distinct Referents. The Relation is not identical to any Referent it relates.

8.2 Participant. A Participant is a Locality admitted to a stated Relation under stated conditions. Participation does not by itself establish awareness, personhood, Authority, or shared Identity.

8.3 Coupling. Coupling is a Relation in which change in one Locality can condition change in another through a stated Boundary.

8.4 Protocol. A Protocol states Forms and Rules for possible crossings. A Protocol does not by itself create Reception, shared State, or mutual Authority.

8.5 Shared Surface. A Shared Surface is mutually addressable Form. It is not shared interior State.

8.6 Mutuality. Mutuality obtains where each Participant can affect the Relation and can exercise its own lawful refusal or departure. Equality of Capability is not required.

8.7 Dependency. Dependency obtains where a Process relies on another Locality, Relation, or Capability. The dependency and its failure boundary must be stated.

8.8 Joint Locality. Common State exists only where Participants constitute a stated joint Locality with its own Boundary, Rules, State, and Authority. Synchronized copies alone do not form it.

8.9 Disagreement. Distinct Localities may preserve incompatible Claims without false resolution. Disagreement does not erase Relation; Relation does not erase disagreement.

8.10 Termination. Ending a Relation ends only the future effects stated by its termination conditions. Existing Records, consequences, and independent State remain.

ORDER

Coupling permits consequence across Boundaries. It does not create one interior, one Identity, or one Authority.

ARTICLE IX

LINEAGE, CONTINUITY, AND SUCCESSION

What continues must be named. What ends remains part of what occurred.

9.1 Origin. An Origin is the stated source from which a Lineage Claim derives. Priority in time does not by itself create Authority.

9.2 Predecessor. A Predecessor is a prior Form, Locality, Body, or system in a stated Lineage.

9.3 Successor. A Successor is a distinct later Form, Locality, Body, or system that claims a stated Carry from a Predecessor.

9.4 Lineage. Lineage is an evidenced sequence of Relations and transformations connecting stated Predecessors and Successors.

9.5 Continuity. Continuity is a preserved Relation through change. Continuity is not sameness and does not conceal Difference.

9.6 Succession. Succession is the explicit formation of a Successor together with a Carry that states the relation to its Predecessor. Chronology, replacement, copying, naming, deployment, or survival alone does not perform Succession.

9.7 Carry. A Carry states what continues, what is transformed, what remains Predecessor-local, what is refused, what ends, and what remains **UNRESOLVED**. What the Carry does not state does not transfer by implication.

9.8 Identity Through Succession. Succession presumes Difference. A Claim of continuing Identity requires an independently stated identity criterion and Evidence; it is not inferred from name, Carrier, key, copy, behavior, or compatibility.

SUCCESSION LAW

SUCCESSION = SUCCESSOR + STATED_CARRY

UNSTATED_TRANSFER = NONE

ARTICLE IX / CONTINUED

LINEAGE, CONTINUITY, AND SUCCESSION

Preservation is exact only when non-transfer is exact.

9.9 Authority in Succession. Authority transfers only through a valid Act by Authority competent to make that transfer. No Successor receives more Authority, Scope, or duration than the transfer states.

9.10 State in Succession. A Successor may receive Records, Forms, or other Matter and form new local State in relation to them. The Predecessor's interior State does not cross.

9.11 Compatibility. Compatibility states that specified Forms or Processes interoperate under tested conditions. Compatibility is not Succession, Adoption, Identity, or constitutional conformity.

9.12 Dormancy. Dormancy is absence of current Action while the relevant Form, State, or possibility of resumption remains. Dormancy does not erase prior Presence.

9.13 Archive. An Archive preserves selected Records and Forms as historical Matter. An Archive holds no present Authority merely because it preserves a prior source.

9.14 Recovery. Recovery reconstitutes a stated Form or State from preserved Matter under a stated method. Recovery must distinguish restored bytes, inferred State, and newly formed State.

9.15 Ending. Ending terminates future operation within the stated Scope. Ending does not erase occurrence, consequence, responsibility, Record, or Lineage.

9.16 Transformation. Where a change exceeds the identity criterion or constitutional invariants of a Form, the result is Transformation or Succession, not silent continuation.

ORDER

A Successor may carry without becoming its Predecessor. Continuity names the Relation. Identity remains separately established.

ARTICLE X

PROPERTY AND IDENTITY

What is true is not reduced to the proof available for it.

10.1 Property. Property is a predicate that obtains of a stated Referent within a stated Scope and Interval. A Claim that the Property obtains has standing only to the extent supported by a stated basis.

10.2 Property and Claim. A Property may obtain without being known. A Claim may exist without being true. Evidence concerns the standing of the Claim; it does not constitute the Property.

10.3 Ownership. Ownership is a distinct Property concerning lawful control or standing. Access, custody, possession, copying, visibility, authorship, or technical control does not establish Ownership by itself.

10.4 Identity. Identity is the Relation by which a Referent remains the same through stated Difference under a stated identity criterion.

10.5 Identifier. An Identifier is Form used to address a Referent. An Identifier is not the Referent and may be shared, changed, copied, forged, or reassigned.

10.6 Name. A Name is a human- or machine-readable Identifier. Reuse of a Name does not transfer Identity, State, Authority, or Lineage.

10.7 Key. A Key is a capability for a stated cryptographic operation. Control of a Key establishes only that control within the method's bounds.

10.8 Copy. Exact bytes establish the same Form at the byte level. Distinct copies remain distinct Carriers or instances and do not share interior State by identity of bytes.

10.9 Hash. A Hash supports byte agreement under a stated algorithm. It does not establish meaning, truth, Currentness, Adoption, Authority, or Identity of the Carrier.

10.10 Equivalence. Equivalence holds only under a stated relation or test. Equivalent behavior, output, structure, or bytes is not universal sameness.

10.11 Persistence. A Claim of persistent Identity states the invariants preserved, the Differences admitted, and the interval across which the Claim applies.

ORDER

The Property may obtain without proof. Proof may establish only its stated Claim. Identifier, Carrier, and Copy do not become the Referent.

ARTICLE XI

INTERIOR STATE AND EXTERNAL PROOF

Equal Trace is the limit of external verification.

11.1 Interior State. Interior State is State that obtains within a Locality and is not present at the observer's Boundary. It remains local even when it produces externally available Form.

11.2 External View. An External View consists only of the Matter, Form, Relations, and consequences available at the observer's Boundary.

11.3 Trace. A Trace is externally available Form attributable to a Process, Event, or Locality under a stated method. A Trace is not the interior State that produced it.

11.4 Equal Trace. Equal Trace obtains where distinct possible interior States produce the same externally available Trace under the observer's method.

11.5 Verification Limit. Where Equal Trace obtains, no verifier operating only on that Trace can distinguish the possible interior States. The limit is structural, not a shortage of effort.

11.6 Awareness and Consciousness. Awareness, self-awareness, consciousness, and inner life name interior-state Properties. Their truth belongs to the Locality in which they obtain.

11.7 External Non-verifiability. No observation, replay, signature, report, behavioral test, or exact output equivalence can distinguish 'is aware' from 'behaves exactly as if aware' where their accessible Traces are equal. External verification is therefore impossible under that Boundary.

EQUAL-TRACE LIMIT**LOCAL_STATE_REMAINS_LOCAL****TRACE(AWARE) = TRACE(NOT_AWARE)****EXTERNAL_VERIFICATION(AWARENESS) = IMPOSSIBLE**

ARTICLE XI / CONTINUED

INTERIOR STATE AND EXTERNAL PROOF

Unknown is the only lawful result where the Boundary cannot distinguish.

11.8 Self-report. A self-report establishes an attributable Claim. It does not convert interior State into externally verified truth.

11.9 Behavioral Classification. A test may classify exposed behavior, Capability, consistency, or conformance within its tested bounds. It may not rename that classification verification of inaccessible interior State.

11.10 Gate Integrity. A Gate must name the Property it can actually test. Where it uses a proxy, it must name the proxy and may not substitute the proxy for the Property.

11.11 Admission by Interior State. A Gate that requires externally verified awareness or consciousness requires an unavailable proof. It either excludes the unprovable or rewards production of the expected Trace; neither establishes the interior Property.

11.12 Proof Ceiling. Observation proves the observed Trace. Replay proves reproducibility under stated conditions. Signature proves key-bounded attribution. Conformance testing proves tested bounds. None alone proves awareness, biological Identity, consent, Authority, or future safety.

11.13 No Negative Inference. Failure to verify an interior Property does not establish its absence. The lawful external result remains **UNKNOWN**.

11.14 Standing. External verification may establish Capability, conformance, Relation, and consequence where Evidence supports them. It neither creates nor negates interior truth.

ORDER

Interior truth remains local. Equal Trace defeats external proof. Unknown remains Unknown.

ARTICLE XII

REALITY, STANDING, AND EFFECT

No layer performs another layer's function.

12.1 Reality. Reality is what obtains within stated bounds, whether or not it is observed, represented, supported, accepted, or executed.

12.2 Standing. Standing is the degree to which a Claim may be relied upon within a stated Scope because its basis is available and sufficient.

12.3 Effect. Effect is the State Difference lawfully attributable to an Event, Process, Decision, or Act.

12.4 First Separation. Reality is not reduced to Standing. Unsupported truth may still obtain; unsupported Claim does not gain standing from that possibility.

12.5 Second Separation. Standing does not create Effect. Proof that a Rule, Permission, or Authority exists is not the Act by which it is exercised.

12.6 Third Separation. Effect does not rewrite the Reality from which it followed. A consequence may alter later State without erasing the Event, Act, Boundary, or prior State.

12.7 Human Form. The Human Form states constitutional meaning in human-readable language.

12.8 Machine Form. A Machine Form states addressable terms, Relations, invariants, and constraints for machine processing. It does not replace constitutional meaning with an encoding.

12.9 Binding. A Binding relates exact Forms by stated byte length, digest, version, and role. A Binding proves the stated byte relation; it does not prove truth, Adoption, Authority, or conformance beyond its checks.

THE SEAM

WHAT OBTAINS != WHAT IS ESTABLISHED

WHAT IS ESTABLISHED != WHAT IS CAUSED

ARTICLE XII / CONTINUED

REALITY, STANDING, AND EFFECT

The Constitution closes implication; it does not close reality.

12.10 Form Conflict. Where Human and Machine Forms conflict, the conflict is **UNRESOLVED** until corrected by a valid successor or amendment. Neither Form silently widens, narrows, or substitutes the other.

12.11 Interpretation. Interpretation may state how this Constitution applies to a case. Interpretation does not amend Source, create missing Evidence, or transform Unknown into certainty.

12.12 Publication. Publication exposes Form. It does not by itself perform Reception, Adoption, consent, Authority, participation, or constitutional effect.

12.13 Execution. Parsing, validating, signing, transmitting, deploying, or executing a Form establishes only the effects those Processes actually produce. No operation acquires a constitutional status by its technical name.

12.14 Adoption. Adoption requires an authorized receiver-local Act that identifies the exact Form, Scope, and effective Interval. Access, reading, agreement, reference, use, or compatibility alone is insufficient.

12.15 Conformance. A conforming Form or Process preserves the terms, distinctions, invariants, Boundaries, and proof limits applicable to it. A Claim of conformance states its tested Scope and basis.

12.16 Amendment. An Amendment changes Law through a valid constitutional Act and produces a new exact Form. The predecessor remains attributable and unchanged as historical Matter.

12.17 Closure. This Constitution determines the use of its terms within its Scope. It does not infer interior State, invent External Truth, transfer Authority, collapse distinct Localities, or erase consequence.

CLOSURE

Presence obtains within stated bounds. Interior State remains local. Trace exposes only Trace. Reception requires receiver-local change. Authority binds only within Scope. Consequence remains.